

flex fuel engines range from E10 (10% ethanol, which is standard unleaded gasoline) to E85 (85% ethanol) and various combinations in between. While these might seem like able substitutes for our age-old gasoline vehicles keeping the environment in mind, they're not practical answers either. Take



the case of Hybrids for example: they're fuel economical, environmentally friendly, look and feel amazing and deliver decent performance. However, financially it doesn't sum up to be all that attractive. On an average, a hybrid car would reduce about a ton of carbon dioxide emission in

the atmosphere, which when converted into carbon credits won't amount to much of a saving. Given the cost of the hybrid engines (compared to normal engine) which can run into lakhs, this doesn't seem viable, does it? Flex fuels that run on ethanol also raise concerns as the process used to make ethanol emits a lot of greenhouse gases.

Most ideas, as they begin, are novel and aimed at serving a purpose. Unfortunately, most of the novelty gets lost in the process of execution, and we end up with something that caters to a completely different purpose behind the veil of goodwill of the original idea. Carbon credits, perhaps is not very different either. With the market being controlled by various groups, corruption and fraud is but inevitable. Carbon credits being the base for the emission trading scheme is a good idea, but loses its way since it's not substantially credible. However, with further improvements to the system, we can expect to see the save the world cause move in the intended direction. 